

household where education was not just a priority, but a passion, I was taught the importance of integrity, hard work, and resilience. My father, Dr. Nissar Ahmed, has been a beacon of inspiration, not just in his academic contributions, but in his unwavering commitment to serving the community. His vision for accessible education and his determination to build PGI from the ground up have shaped my approach to leadership and education. My mother, Mrs. Kauser Nissar Ahmed, has also played a crucial role in shaping my character — teaching me the importance of compassion, multi-tasking, and balance. Her support and guidance have been invaluable. Their influence is what drives me every day to continue their legacy and to ensure that PGI remains a place of excellence, innovation, and inclusive growth.

India is maturing into an affordable global hub for quality education. How is PGI aligned to this assessment of an institution of higher education?

India is increasingly becoming a global center for accessible and high-quality education. At Presidency Group of Institutions (PGI), we are fully aligned with this transformative shift. Presidency University, through its autonomy, offers programs that meet international standards, ensuring that our students receive world-class education at affordable rates. The University has partnered with 150 plus prestigious international universities, focusing on academic and research collaboration. Many of our students benefit from pursuing higher professional education with these esteemed global institutions. Additionally, our campus hosts a growing number of international students, underscoring PGI's reputation as a key player in global education. Our ongoing international partnerships and our commitment to

quality, affordability, and innovation position us at the forefront of India's educational evolution.

Of late, what are the new colleges that have come up under the aegis of PGI or those on the flanks to be inaugurated?

Presidency University has been proactive in expanding the scope of programs under the University's umbrella. Recently, several new schools and faculties have been launched to offer cutting-edge, industry-driven courses. These programs reflect the evolving needs of both the job market and academic innovation. We have also introduced technology-focused programs that prepare students to be industry-ready in fields like AI, robotics, and data science. Looking ahead, we are excited about the possibility of opening a School of Liberal Studies that will offer a diverse array of programs, ranging from Fine Arts to Performing Arts. PGI's vision remains forward-looking, with plans for continuous growth and academic diversification.

What are your expansion plans for PGI campuses in other parts of Karnataka or in any other part of the country?

As a state private university, Presidency University is currently focused on expanding within Karnataka. Over the next few years, we also plan to establish new pre-university college campuses across the state, continuing to build on our reputation for academic excellence. We will adopt a cautious, research-based approach to this expansion, assessing the educational landscape and environmental factors before making any strategic decisions.

Karnataka is an IT and industrial hub of the country. How are you aligning the New Education Policy for encouraging experiential learning for the students to become industry-

worthy?

Presidency University has embraced the key principles outlined in the New Education Policy (NEP) 2020, particularly its emphasis on interdisciplinary education and experiential learning. Our curriculum is designed to foster both academic excellence and research-driven knowledge. We have implemented the Outcome-Based Learning (OBL) model and adopted a Choice-Based Credit System (CBCS), offering a mix of core subjects, electives, and hands-on learning experiences such as internships and capstone projects. These initiatives ensure that our students gain practical, real-world skills, positioning them as industry-ready professionals. Furthermore, the university's emphasis on industry collaborations allows students to engage with leading IT and industrial sectors, ensuring that their learning experience is relevant, dynamic, and tailored to the demands of the job market.

A Legacy of Family Values and Visionary Leadership

The success of PGI is deeply rooted in the values upheld by its leadership. Dr. Nissar Ahmed's vision for quality education, his commitment to social good, and his philanthropic spirit have been the guiding lights for PGI's growth. The involvement of his wife and children in continuing his work ensures that these values remain at the heart of the institution's operations.

At PGI, the legacy of excellence, innovation, and cultural sensitivity continues to shape the minds of young leaders. As the institution prepares for the next chapter, it remains steadfast in its mission to provide affordable, world-class education while preparing students to thrive in a globalized world.

